

Code of Conduct

Standards of professional behavior and ethical guidelines

Version:	v4.0	Effective Date:	January 1, 2024
Department:	Human Resources	Applies To:	All Employees

1. Introduction

Acme Technologies is committed to maintaining a professional, respectful, and ethical workplace. This Code of Conduct applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, and interns at all locations and during all company-related activities, including travel, events, and online communications.

2. Core Values

Value	What It Means
Integrity	Act honestly and transparently in all interactions
Respect	Treat every individual with dignity regardless of role
Excellence	Deliver quality work and take ownership of outcomes
Collaboration	Work openly with teammates and across departments
Innovation	Embrace change and encourage creative thinking
Accountability	Take responsibility for actions and decisions

3. Professional Conduct

3.1 Workplace Behavior

- Maintain punctuality and meet commitments reliably
- Communicate clearly, professionally, and respectfully
- Resolve disagreements through dialogue and escalate only when necessary
- Dress appropriately for office and client-facing situations
- Keep workspaces clean and shared areas tidy

3.2 Use of Company Resources

- Company equipment, systems, and software must be used for work purposes
- Personal use of company devices should be minimal and not disruptive
- Company credit cards and expense accounts must not be used for personal expenses
- Misuse of company resources is grounds for disciplinary action

4. Anti-Harassment and Discrimination

Acme Technologies has zero tolerance for harassment, discrimination, or bullying of any kind. All employees have the right to a safe and inclusive work environment.

Prohibited conduct includes but is not limited to:

- Verbal, physical, or visual harassment based on gender, race, religion, caste, age, disability, or sexual orientation
- Sexual harassment as defined under the POSH Act 2013
- Cyberbullying or harassment through digital channels
- Discrimination in hiring, promotion, or assignment of work
- Retaliation against employees who report harassment in good faith

Complaints must be reported to the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) at posh@acme.com. All complaints will be investigated within 30 days and treated with strict confidentiality.

5. Conflict of Interest

- Employees must disclose any personal or financial interest that may conflict with company interests
- Outside employment or consulting must be disclosed and approved by HR
- Employees must not use company information for personal financial gain
- Gifts from vendors or clients exceeding Rs. 1,000 in value must be disclosed

6. Confidentiality and Data Privacy

- All business information — client data, financial records, product plans — is confidential
- Employees must not share confidential information with unauthorized parties
- Confidentiality obligations continue for 2 years after leaving the company
- Violations may result in legal action in addition to disciplinary measures

7. Social Media

- Do not share company confidential information on social media
- Personal opinions must be clearly distinguished from company positions
- Do not post negative comments about colleagues, clients, or competitors
- Company logo and branding must not be used without approval

8. Disciplinary Action

Violation Level	Examples	Consequence
Minor	Late attendance, minor policy breach	Verbal warning
Moderate	Repeated lateness, resource misuse	Written warning, PIP
Major	Harassment, data breach, fraud	Suspension or termination
Gross Misconduct	Criminal activity, violence	Immediate termination

9. Reporting Violations

Employees are encouraged to report any violations of this code through the following channels: Manager or HR (hr@acme.com), Anonymous Ethics Hotline (ethics@acme.com), or Internal Complaints Committee (posh@acme.com). Retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith is strictly prohibited.